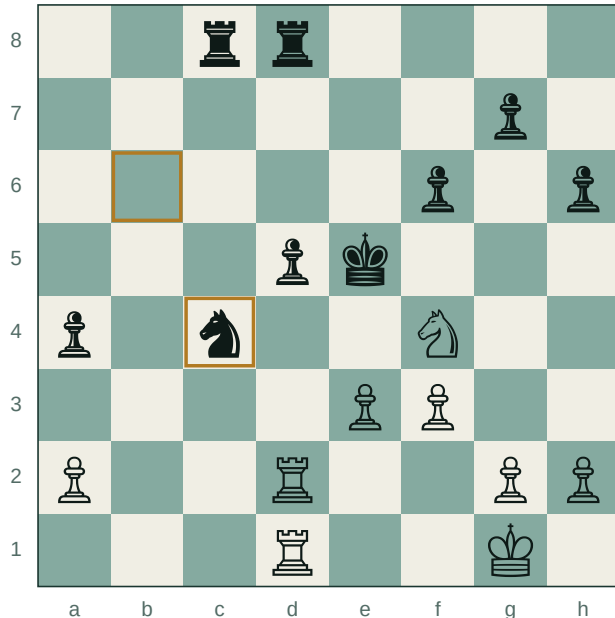


# Hook mating nets: White, move 31

Hook mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 30...Nxc4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 31. Rxd5+ Rxd5 32. Rxd5#

**31.Rxd5+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From d5 it attacks king on e5 and rook on d8. Recorded reply: **31...Rxd5**.

**32.Rxd5#** Mate: rook on d5 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e5. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

### CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on d5. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A hook-type mating net combines rook pressure with knight control and supporting pawn geometry. The supporting pieces can matter more than the apparent value of a sacrifice.

### HOW TO LOOK

Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on e5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.